



Microbes break down animals as well as plants.



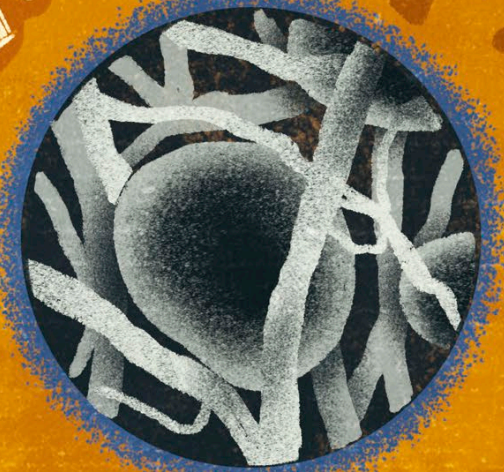
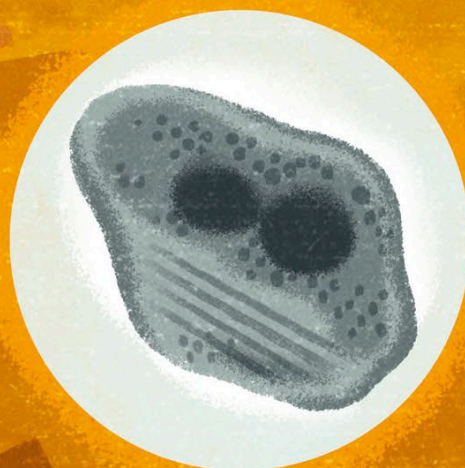
Eco-warrior

Methane is a greenhouse gas that causes global warming. *Methylocapsa gorgona* takes methane out of the air, because it needs the gas to survive.



Food fixer

Some plants would find it tricky to survive without bacteria such as *rhizobia*. This type of microbe takes a gas called nitrogen from the air and uses it to make plant food.



Transformer

Fungi such as *Mortierella* break down dead plants and animals into new material. Other living things can then eat the broken-down material.